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INCE ASHISH KAPOOR booked an apartment in a Jaypee Infratech project in Noida more than a decade ago, he has moved from his rented place in South Delhi to a rented apartment in Gurugram, turned 60, and seen his son grow up from being a student to becoming a professional. Throughout this time, the only thing that has remained constant is his yearning for his own home. There are at least 20,000 others like

Kapoor who face this predicament.

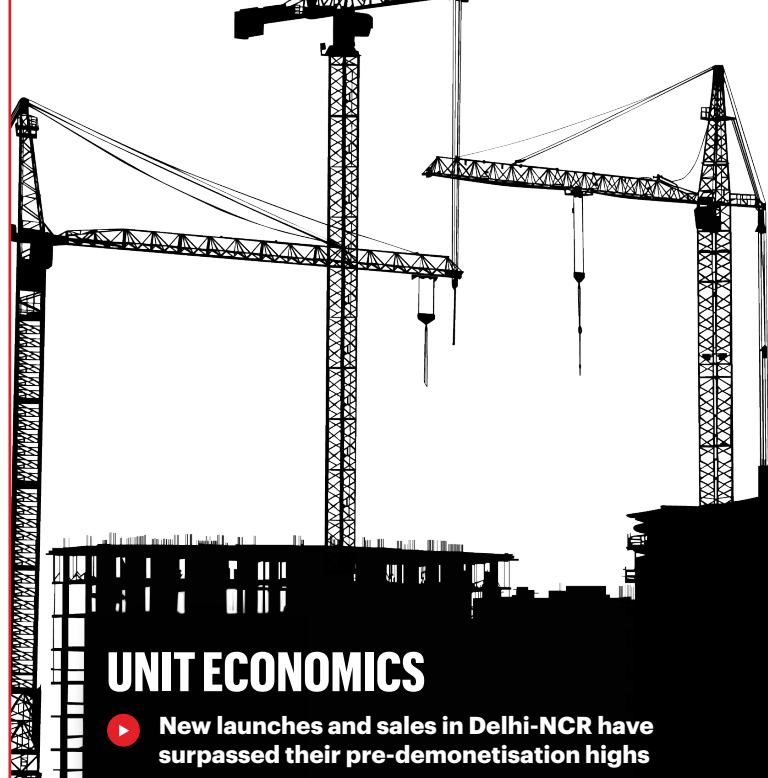
The genesis of their problem lies in the 32,700 residential units booked between 2007 and 2011 under various Jaypee Infratech Ltd (JIL) projects, of which over 20,000 remain undelivered even after a decade. A report filed by the interim resolution professional in the Supreme Court says the Jaypee Group had collected at least ₹13,364 crore from homebuyers in booking amounts and advance payments till it went into insolvency in September 2017. JIL is not the sole offender; there are others like it. Take the case of Amrapali Group, another Noida-based realty major, whose promoters are languishing in jail on charges of duping homebuyers.

A close look at the 2011-15 period throws up a stark picture of real estate firms duping homebuyers, which eroded trust in the once booming market, and by the mid-2010s, brought it to a grinding halt. After that, the Delhi-National Capital Region (Delhi-NCR) market suffered from subdued demand, few new launches, and a lack of price appreciation. But not anymore. The residential real estate market in the Delhi-NCR—particularly the micro-markets of Noida-Greater Noida—is finally looking up as customers make a beeline for homes.

Data from property consultants Knight Frank India shows that sales and new launches have bounced back to pre-2015 levels, after the pandemic receded in 2022. Further, in the first half of 2023, residential sales touched 30,114 units, the highest in 10 years. In the previous two half-yearly periods—January-June 2022 and July-December 2022—the market had recorded sales of 29,359 and 29,101 units, respectively; both higher than any half-yearly period since 2013.

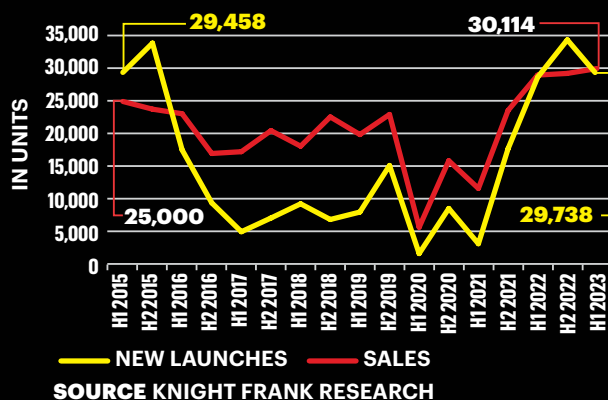
BOTTLED UP DEMAND

As homebuyers have started flocking to the market, developers have upped their game too. Data from Knight Frank shows developers launched 34,507 units in H2 2022, followed by 29,738 units in H1 2023 in Delhi-NCR;



UNIT ECONOMICS

- ▶ **New launches and sales in Delhi-NCR have surpassed their pre-demonetisation highs**
- ▶ **Renewed demand and stable regulations have boosted the residential real estate market in NCR**



these are more than the launches in any such period in nearly a decade. In fact, from the time economic activity started picking up in late-2021, both new launches and sales of residential units have been rising steadily. According to analysts at Knight Frank, the market witnessed steady home-buying demand in H1 2023 due to two factors. First, the pause in the repo rate hike cycle announced in February 2023 brought relief to homebuyers, and second, any new inventory coming to the market from credible developers is being lapped up by interested homebuyers as a lack of ready-to-move-in inventory had bottled up demand.

“The Delhi-NCR real estate sector is revitalised, witnessing triple-digit growth in new property supply. This